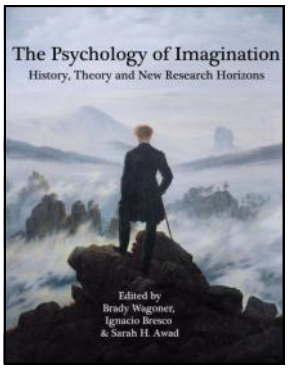
New Book Information



The Psychology of Imagination: History, Theory and New Research Horizons

Editors: **Brady Wagoner**, *Aalborg University*,
Ignacio Bresco de Luna, *Aalborg University*
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A volume in **Niels Bohr Professorship Lectures in Cultural Psychology**
Series Editor: Brady Wagoner, Aalborg University

Cultural Psychology offers a new approach to imagination which brings its emotional, social, cultural, contextual and existential characteristics to the fore. In this approach, fantasy and imagination are understood as the human capacity to distance oneself from the here-and-now situation in order to return to it with new possibilities. To do this we use social-cultural means (e.g. language, stories, art, images, etc.) to conceive of imaginary scenarios, some of which may become real. Imagination is involved in every situation of our lives, though to different degrees. Sometimes this process can lead to concrete products (e.g., artistic works) that can be picked up and used by others for the purposes of their imagining. Imagination is not seen here as an isolated cognitive faculty but as the means by which people anticipate and constructively move towards an indeterminate future. It is in this process of living forward with the help of imagination that novelty appears and social change becomes possible. This book offers a conceptual history of imagination, an array of theoretical approaches, imagination's use in psychologist's thinking and a number of new research areas. Its aim is to offer a re-enchantment of the concept of imagination and the discipline of psychology more generally.

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